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Menus

Menus are one type of backend for Graphical User Interfaces, or GUIs; they handle the logic involved in interacting with some resource to indirectly modify the internal data holder state. As such, a data holder should not be directly coupled to any menu, instead pass the data holder to the menu.

MenuType

Menus are created and removed dynamically and as such are not registry objects. As such, another factory object is registered in the registry:

`MenuType`s must be registered.

MenuSupplier

A `MenuType` is created by passing in a `MenuSupplier` and a `FeatureFlagSet` to its constructor. A `MenuSupplier` represents a menu, and returns a newly created `AbstractContainerMenu`.

```
// For some DeferredRegister<MenuType<?>> REGISTER
public static final RegistryObject<MenuType<MyMenu>> MY_MENU = REGISTER.register("my_menu", () ->

// In MyMenu, an AbstractContainerMenu subclass
public MyMenu(int containerId, Inventory playerInv) {
    super(MY_MENU.get(), containerId);
    // ...
}
```

Note

The container identifier is unique for an individual player. This means that the same container id on two different players will result in two different menus.

The `MenuSupplier` is usually responsible for creating a menu on the client with dummy data references used to store and interact with the data holder.

IContainerFactory

If additional information is needed on the client (e.g. the position of the data holder in the world), then the subclass `IContainerFactory` provides a `FriendlyByteBuf` which can store additional information that was sent from the server. A `MenuType` can be created with a `IContainerFactory`.

```
// For some DeferredRegister<MenuType<?>> REGISTER
public static final RegistryObject<MenuType<MyMenuExtra>> MY_MENU_EXTRA = REGISTER.register("my_menu_extra", () ->

// In MyMenuExtra, an AbstractContainerMenu subclass
public MyMenuExtra(int containerId, Inventory playerInv, FriendlyByteBuf extraData) {
    super(MY_MENU_EXTRA.get(), containerId);
    // Store extra data from buffer
    // ...
}
```

AbstractContainerMenu

All menus are extended from `AbstractContainerMenu`. A menu takes in two parameters, the `MenuType`, which represents the menu type, and the `Inventory`, which represents the current accessor.

Important

The player can only have 100 unique menus open at once.

Each menu should contain two constructors: one used to initialize the menu on the server and one used to initialize the menu on the client. Any fields that the server menu constructor contains should have some default for the client menu constructor.

```
// Client menu constructor
public MyMenu(int containerId, Inventory playerInventory) {
    this(containerId, playerInventory);
}

// Server menu constructor
public MyMenu(int containerId, Inventory playerInventory) {
    // ...
}
```

Each menu implementation must implement two methods: `#stillValid` and `#quickMoveStack`.

#stillValid and ContainerLevelAccess

`#stillValid` determines whether the menu should remain open for a given player. This is typically directed to the static `#stillValid` attached to. The client menu must always return `true` for this method, which the static `#stillValid` does default to. This is located in `AbstractContainerMenu`.

A `ContainerLevelAccess` supplies the current level and location of the block within an enclosed scope. When constructing the client menu, the client menu constructor can pass in `ContainerLevelAccess.NULL`, which will do nothing.

```
// Client menu constructor
public MyMenuAccess(int containerId, Inventory playerInventory) {
    this(containerId, playerInventory, ContainerLevelAccess.NULL);
}

// Server menu constructor
public MyMenuAccess(int containerId, Inventory playerInventory, ContainerLevelAccess access) {
    // ...
}

// Assume this menu is attached to RegistryObject<Block> MY_BLOCK
@Override
public boolean stillValid(Player player) {
    return AbstractContainerMenu.stillValid(this.access, player, MY_BLOCK.get());
}
```

Data Synchronization

Some data needs to be present on both the server and the client to display to the player. To do this, the menu implements a `ba` synced to the client. For players, this is checked every tick.

Minecraft supports two forms of data synchronization by default: `ItemStack`s via `Slot`s and integers via `DataSlot`s. `Slot` player in a screen, assuming the action is valid. These can be added to a menu within the constructor through `#addSlot` and `#`

Note

Since `Container`s used by `Slot`s are deprecated by Forge in favor of using the `IItemHandler` capability, the rest of the e

A `SlotItemHandler` contains four parameters: the `IItemHandler` representing the inventory the stacks are within, the inc position of the slot will render on the screen relative to `AbstractContainerScreen#leftPos` and `#topPos`. The client men

In most cases, any slots the menu contains is first added, followed by the player's inventory, and finally concluded with the pl upon the order of which slots were added.

A `DataSlot` is an abstract class which should implement a getter and setter to reference the data stored in the c `DataSlot#standalone`.

These, along with slots, should be recreated every time a new menu is initialized.

Warning

Although a `DataSlot` stores an integer, it is effectively limited to a **short** (-32768 to 32767) because of how it sends the value

```
// Assume we have an inventory from a data object of size 5
// Assume we have a DataSlot constructed on each initialization of the server menu

// Client menu constructor
public MyMenuAccess(int containerId, Inventory playerInventory) {
    this(containerId, playerInventory, new ItemStackHandler(5), DataSlot.standalone());
}

// Server menu constructor
public MyMenuAccess(int containerId, Inventory playerInventory, IItemHandler dataInventory, DataS
    // Check if the data inventory size is some fixed value
    // Then, add slots for data inventory
    this.addSlot(new SlotItemHandler(dataInventory, /*...*/));

    // Add slots for player inventory
    this.addSlot(new Slot(playerInventory, /*...*/));

    // Add data slots for handled integers
    this.addDataSlot(dataSingle);

    // ...
}
```

ContainerData

If multiple integers need to be synced to the client, a `ContainerData` can be used to reference the integers instead. T `ContainerData`s can also be constructed in the data object itself if the `ContainerData` is added to the menu through `#` interface. The client menu constructor should always supply a new instance via `SimpleContainerData`.

```
// Assume we have a ContainerData of size 3

// Client menu constructor
public MyMenuAccess(int containerId, Inventory playerInventory) {
    this(containerId, playerInventory, new SimpleContainerData(3));
}

// Server menu constructor
public MyMenuAccess(int containerId, Inventory playerInventory, ContainerData dataMultiple) {
    // Check if the ContainerData size is some fixed value
    checkContainerDataCount(dataMultiple, 3);

    // Add data slots for handled integers
    this.addDataSlots(dataMultiple);
}
```

```
// ...
}
```

Warning

As `ContainerData` delegates to `DataSlot`s, these are also limited to a **short** (-32768 to 32767).

#quickMoveStack

`#quickMoveStack` is the second method that must be implemented by any menu. This method is called whenever a stack has its previous slot or there is no other place for the stack to go. The method returns a copy of the stack in the slot being quick move

Stacks are typically moved between slots using `#moveItemStackTo`, which moves the stack into the first available slot. It takes index (exclusive), and whether to check the slots from first to last (when `false`) or from last to first (when `true`).

Across Minecraft implementations, this method is fairly consistent in its logic:

```
// Assume we have a data inventory of size 5
// The inventory has 4 inputs (index 1 - 4) which outputs to a result slot (index 0)
// We also have the 27 player inventory slots and the 9 hotbar slots
// As such, the actual slots are indexed like so:
// - Data Inventory: Result (0), Inputs (1 - 4)
// - Player Inventory (5 - 31)
// - Player Hotbar (32 - 40)
@Override
public ItemStack quickMoveStack(Player player, int quickMovedSlotIndex) {
    // The quick moved slot stack
    ItemStack quickMovedStack = ItemStack.EMPTY;
    // The quick moved slot
    Slot quickMovedSlot = this.slots.get(quickMovedSlotIndex)

    // If the slot is in the valid range and the slot is not empty
    if (quickMovedSlot != null && quickMovedSlot.hasItem()) {
        // Get the raw stack to move
        ItemStack rawStack = quickMovedSlot.getItem();
        // Set the slot stack to a copy of the raw stack
        quickMovedStack = rawStack.copy();

        /*
        The following quick move logic can be simplified to if in data inventory,
        try to move to player inventory/hotbar and vice versa for containers
        that cannot transform data (e.g. chests).
        */

        // If the quick move was performed on the data inventory result slot
        if (quickMovedSlotIndex == 0) {
            // Try to move the result slot into the player inventory/hotbar
            if (!this.moveItemStackTo(rawStack, 5, 41, true)) {
                // If cannot move, no longer quick move
                return ItemStack.EMPTY;
            }

            // Perform logic on result slot quick move
            slot.onQuickCraft(rawStack, quickMovedStack);
        }
        // Else if the quick move was performed on the player inventory or hotbar slot
        else if (quickMovedSlotIndex >= 5 && quickMovedSlotIndex < 41) {
            // Try to move the inventory/hotbar slot into the data inventory input slots
            if (!this.moveItemStackTo(rawStack, 1, 5, false)) {
                // If cannot move and in player inventory slot, try to move to hotbar
                if (quickMovedSlotIndex < 32) {
                    if (!this.moveItemStackTo(rawStack, 32, 41, false)) {
                        // If cannot move, no longer quick move
                        return ItemStack.EMPTY;
                    }
                }
            }
            // Else try to move hotbar into player inventory slot
            else if (!this.moveItemStackTo(rawStack, 5, 32, false)) {
                // If cannot move, no longer quick move
                return ItemStack.EMPTY;
            }
        }
    }
    // Else if the quick move was performed on the data inventory input slots, try to move to pla
    else if (!this.moveItemStackTo(rawStack, 5, 41, false)) {
        // If cannot move, no longer quick move
        return ItemStack.EMPTY;
    }

    if (rawStack.isEmpty()) {
        // If the raw stack has completely moved out of the slot, set the slot to the empty stack
        quickMovedSlot.set(ItemStack.EMPTY);
    } else {
        // Otherwise, notify the slot that the stack count has changed
        quickMovedSlot.setChanged();
    }
}
```

```

    }

    /*
     * The following if statement and Slot#onTake call can be removed if the
     * menu does not represent a container that can transform stacks (e.g.
     * chests).
     */
    if (rawStack.getCount() == quickMovedStack.getCount()) {
        // If the raw stack was not able to be moved to another slot, no longer quick move
        return ItemStack.EMPTY;
    }
    // Execute logic on what to do post move with the remaining stack
    quickMovedSlot.onTake(player, rawStack);
}

return quickMovedStack; // Return the slot stack
}

```

Opening a Menu

Once a menu type has been registered, the menu itself has been finished, and a [screen](#) has been attached, a menu can then be opened on the server. The method takes in the player opening the menu, the [MenuProvider](#) of the server side menu, and optionally a [FriendlyByteBuf](#).

Note

[NetworkHooks#openScreen](#) with the [FriendlyByteBuf](#) parameter should only be used if a menu type was created using

MenuProvider

A [MenuProvider](#) is an interface that contains two methods: [#createMenu](#), which creates the server instance of the menu, and [#openScreen](#). The [#createMenu](#) method contains three parameters: the container id of the menu, the inventory of the player who opened the menu, and the player.

A [MenuProvider](#) can easily be created using [SimpleMenuProvider](#), which takes in a method reference to create the server instance.

```

// In some implementation
NetworkHooks.openScreen(serverPlayer, new SimpleMenuProvider(
    (containerId, playerInventory, player) -> new MyMenu(containerId, playerInventory),
    Component.translatable("menu.title.examplemod.mymenu")
));

```

Common Implementations

Menus are typically opened on a player interaction of some kind (e.g. when a block or entity is right-clicked).

Block Implementation

Blocks typically implement a menu by overriding [BlockBehaviour#use](#). If on the logical client, the interaction returns [InteractionResult#CONSUME](#). If on the server, it opens the menu.

The [MenuProvider](#) should be implemented by overriding [BlockBehaviour#getMenuProvider](#). Vanilla methods use this to

```

// In some Block subclass
@Override
public MenuProvider getMenuProvider(BlockState state, Level level, BlockPos pos) {
    return new SimpleMenuProvider(/* ... */);
}

@Override
public InteractionResult use(BlockState state, Level level, BlockPos pos, Player player, InteractionHand hand) {
    if (!level.isClientSide && player instanceof ServerPlayer serverPlayer) {
        NetworkHooks.openScreen(serverPlayer, state.getMenuProvider(level, pos));
    }
    return InteractionResult.sidedSuccess(level.isClientSide);
}

```

Note

This is the simplest way to implement the logic, not the only way. If you want the block to only open the menu under certain conditions, you can return [InteractionResult#PASS](#) or [InteractionResult#FAIL](#) if the conditions are not met.

Mob Implementation

Mobs typically implement a menu by overriding [Mob#mobInteract](#). This is done similarly to the block implementation with the addition of a spectator mode viewing.

```

public class MyMob extends Mob implements MenuProvider {
    // ...

    @Override
    public InteractionResult mobInteract(Player player, InteractionHand hand) {
        if (!this.level.isClientSide && player instanceof ServerPlayer serverPlayer) {
            NetworkHooks.openScreen(serverPlayer, this);
        }
        return InteractionResult.sidedSuccess(this.level.isClientSide);
    }
}

```

Note

Once again, this is the simplest way to implement the logic, not the only way.

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